

3	Identities and inequalities	Notes
	Simple algebraic division. The factor and remainder theorems. Solutions of equations, extended to include the simultaneous solution of one linear and one quadratic equation in two variables. Simple inequalities, linear and quadratic. The graphical representation of linear inequalities in two variables.	Division by $(x + a)$, $(x - a)$, $(ax + b)$ or $(ax - b)$ will be required. Students should know that if $f(x) = 0$ when $x = a$, then $(x - a)$ is a factor of $f(x)$. Students may be required to factorise cubic expressions such as: $x^3 + 3x^2 - 4$ and $6x^3 + 11x^2 - x - 6$, when a factor has been provided. Students should be familiar with the terms 'quotient' and 'remainder' and be able to determine the remainder when the polynomial $f(x)$ is divided by $(ax + b)$ or $(ax - b)$. The solution of a cubic equation containing at least one rational root may be set. For example $ax + b > cx + d$, $px^2 + qx + r < sx^2 + tx + u$. The emphasis will be on simple questions designed to test fundamental principles. Simple problems on linear programming may be set.